



Global Harassment, Discrimination & Workplace Bullying Prevention Policy

Scope

All Cognizant Associates are expected to comply with this policy, which is designed to promote compliance with our [Code of Ethics](#) and local laws throughout our operations. This includes all directors, officers, and employees of Cognizant entities, subsidiaries and joint ventures over which Cognizant has operational control, in the course of employment, virtually or in-person (collectively “Associates”). Cognizant expects the same high standards of behavior from its suppliers, business partners, contract workforce and any other visitors. If there is a concern, we will refer the same to their respective employer.

Guiding principles

At Cognizant, we take great pride in creating an environment where everyone can thrive, feel safe and be included. That means that we must treat each other with dignity, fairness and respect. We must value everyone's unique contribution and promote an inclusive Work Environment. This creates diverse teams and a workplace where everyone can bring their whole selves to work and belong.

To achieve the above objective, this policy articulates our collective responsibility to [work as one](#) and create a Work Environment that is free of any behavior which could be interpreted or perceived as Harassment, Discrimination and Bullying and Workplace Violence.

Cognizant will not tolerate any conduct that violates this policy or permit Discrimination, Harassment, Retaliation, Bullying, Workplace Violence and any actions that are unlawful or pertain to Legally Protected Characteristics in countries or regions where we operate.

In addition to complying with the standards set out in this policy, Associates are expected to behave consistent with Cognizant's [Code of Ethics](#), [Human Rights Policy](#), [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#), and [External Communication](#) & [Social Media Policy](#), the company's

Translations

简体中文

Français Canada

Français France

Deutschland

日本語

Brasil Português

Latinoamérica Español

Polish

Key Definitions

Legally Protected Characteristics: specific aspects, characteristics or any other status protected by applicable national or local law

Work Environment: location where someone works or is performing work duties or any location the company deems to be a Work Environment (i.e., client office, restaurants, and areas surrounding the office building); includes virtual work arrangements.

Related Policies & Processes

- [Code of Ethics](#)
- [Human Rights Policy](#)
- [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#)
- [External Communication and Social Media Policy](#)
- [Ethics & Compliance Training Policy](#)

regional and country policies on the topics of Harassment, Discrimination, and Bullying, and local laws and regulations, including situations where a specific circumstance is not explicitly defined within this policy. If local law imposes stricter requirements than those described in this policy, we must comply with the local requirements.

Discrimination

We never discriminate against a person's Legally Protected Characteristics, such as race, color, religion, gender identity, pregnancy, age, national origin, sexual orientation, marital status, disability status, veteran status or freedom of association including political affiliations and union memberships, when we make employment decisions including recruiting, hiring, training, promotion, termination, or providing other terms and conditions of employment. The legal definition of Discrimination varies based on local law. For purposes of this policy, Discrimination is defined as treating a person or group of people differently, or less favorably because of a Legally Protected Characteristic.

Actions or behavior that could be interpreted or perceived as discriminatory will not be tolerated, including, but is not limited to:

- discouraging someone from applying for a role because of their gender or gender identity, marital or parental status
- basing a promotion decision on an Associate's gender or race
- assigning work tasks based on individual's gender or religious caste

Harassment

The legal definition of Harassment varies based on local law. For purposes of this policy, Harassment, including Sexual Harassment, is defined as unwanted conduct based on a Legally Protected Characteristic that has the purpose or effect of violating an individual's dignity or creating an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating, or offensive environment.

Actions or behavior that could be interpreted or perceived as harassing will not be tolerated, including, but is not limited to:

- threatening and intimidating behavior of any kind
- participating in hostile acts
- initiating or engaging in offensive communications
- using jokes, comments, slurs, epithets, stories, questions, stereotyping, and disparaging comments towards an individual, characteristic or group of people
- displaying or sharing offensive material

Sexual Harassment can be sexual in nature or based on a person's real or perceived gender, gender identity or sexual orientation. Local law may further define Sexual Harassment. Actions or behavior that could be interpreted or perceived as Sexual Harassment will not be tolerated, including, but is not limited to:

- initiating or engaging in offensive communications
- using jokes, comments, stories, questions and stereotyping
- engaging in unwanted touching of any kind or invasion of personal space
- flirting or pursuing someone persistently against their will
- whistling; leering; improper gestures; offensive, derogatory or degrading remarks
- making graphic comments about another person's body
- playing gender or sex-based pranks
- initiating quid pro quo, or "this for that", demands for sexual favors as a condition of

employment or in exchange for favorable or preferential treatment

Workplace bullying

Bullying is repeated harmful or mean-spirited, targeted behavior, which is not necessarily based on a Legally Protected Characteristic that is objectively intimidating, threatening, or humiliating to the target. Local law may further define Bullying. Actions or behavior that could objectively be interpreted or perceived as Workplace Bullying include, but are not limited to:

- participating in public ridicule, written or verbal
- intentionally sabotaging the work of another
- shouting, yelling or other aggressive communication, both written and verbal
- publicly shaming
- using offensive nicknames
- pushing, shoving, kicking, poking, and tripping
- assaulting or threatening assault, including making intimidating gestures inflicting intentional and targeted damage to another person's personal property or work area

Supervisors, managers or others should act on behalf of the company in a respectful, professional manner in accordance with company policies and procedures. As such, Harassment and Workplace Bullying does not include:

- providing feedback and direction, critiquing performance or work product and conducting performance reviews, and issuing counseling or disciplinary action when necessary
- being part of disagreements, conflicts, or misunderstandings that are managed in a respectful and professional manner
- engaging in mutually agreeable interactions that don't impact the Work Environment or other Associates in a negative way

Workplace violence

At Cognizant, Workplace Violence is defined as any act of violence or threat of violence that occurs in a place of employment. This could be any verbal or written statement, including but not limited to texts, emails, social media posts, or any behavioral or physical conduct that shows an intention / perceived as intending to cause physical harm or fear of physical harm.

Workplace violence therefore includes but is not limited to:

- The threat or use of physical force that results in, or has a high likelihood of resulting in, injury, psychological trauma, or stress, regardless of whether the target sustains an injury.
- An incident involving a threat or use of a firearm or other dangerous weapon, including the use of common objects as weapons, regardless of whether the target sustains an injury.

Disciplinary consequences

Subject to local laws and regulations, a violation of this policy could result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. If you are aware of a violation of this policy, you have an obligation to report it to the Company. As stated in Cognizant's [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#), Cognizant does not tolerate retaliation against any individual who submits a good faith report of a violation or possible violation of law, the [Code of Ethics](#), or other Cognizant policies.

To report a possible violation of this policy, visit Cognizant's Compliance Helpline (a secure and confidential reporting system) at: www.cognizant.com/compliance-helpline.

Policy modifications

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the Global Harassment Discrimination and Bullying Prevention Policy will be approved by the Chief People Officer.

Version history

Revision Date	Description of Change
AUG-25-2021	Initial Release
MAY-19-2023	Standardization of template
DEC-20-2024	Included section on Workplace violence Added policy modifications section Added US, India, Colombia, Chile Addendums in Appendix A
NOV-27-2025	Updated Links

Policy control information

Policy Name: Global Harassment, Discrimination & Workplace Bullying Prevention Policy **Department:** Human Resources

Revision Date: NOV-27-2025

Effective Date: AUG-25-2021

Policy Owner: Chief People Officer

Appendix A - Country addendums

Addendum table of content

[Chile addendum](#)

[Colombia addendum](#)

[India addendum](#)

[United States addendum](#)

Chile

Principles of employment relationships

In accordance with Chilean Employment Law, labor relationships must always be based on a treatment free of violence, compatible with the dignity of the person and with gender perspective. These principles must be considered both for the application and for the interpretation of all labor regulations.

Regarding gender perspective it is specified that, for the purposes of the Law, this implies “the adoption of measures to promote equality and eradicate discrimination based on such grounds”.

Obligations, prohibitions and procedures applicable within Cognizant for the purpose of preventing, investigating and sanctioning labor harassment, sexual harassment and workplace violence are established in the Internal Regulation (“Reglamento Interno de Orden, Higiene y Seguridad”) provided to Chilean Associates.

Definition of sexual harassment

Chilean regulations define sexual harassment as any inappropriate sexual requests made by a person, through any means, that are not consented by the recipient and that threaten or harm their employment situation or opportunities.

Definition of workplace harassment or mobbing

Chilean regulations define workplace harassment as any conduct that constitutes aggression or harassment exercised by Cognizant or by one or more Associate against another or other Associates, by any means, whether it is manifested once or repeatedly, and that results in the affected worker or workers being undermined, mistreated or humiliated, or that threatens or harms their employment situation or their employment opportunities.

Definition of workplace violence

Chilean legislation defines Workplace Violence as that exercised by third parties outside the labor relationship, being understood as those conducts that affect the Associates, on the occasion of the provision of services, by clients, suppliers or users, among others.

Definition of discrimination

Chilean legislation defines Discrimination as the distinctions, exclusions or preferences based on race, color, sex, maternity, breastfeeding, age, marital status, union membership, religion, political opinion, nationality, national ascendancy, socioeconomic status, language, beliefs, participation in labor organizations, sexual orientation, gender identity, filiation, personal appearance, illness or disability, social origin or any other reason, which are intended to nullify or alter equality of opportunity or treatment in employment and occupation.

Reporting channels and investigation procedure

Refer to the [procedure document](#) to know about the investigation procedure.

Prevention of sexual Harassment, workplace harassment and workplace violence

For the purpose of preventing the occurrence of sexual harassment, workplace harassment or workplace violence, Cognizant shall implement a Prevention Protocol for such matter, which shall be included in Cognizant’s Internal Regulation.

Please find the Spanish version of the policy [here](#).

Colombia

Cognizant is committed to maintaining a work environment that is free from harassment where Associates at all levels are able to devote their full attention and best efforts to the job.

Harassment, either intentional or unintentional, has no place in the work environment. Offenders shall be subject to stringent action as per Law 1010 of 2006, which defines, prevents, corrects and sanctions any form of harassment in the workplace.

Definition of workplace harassment

According to article 2 of the mentioned law, Workplace harassment refers to persistent and verifiable behavior directed at an Associate by the company, their representatives, superiors, colleagues, or subordinates. This behavior aims to instill fear, intimidation, terror, and anxiety, causing prejudice at work and potentially leading to demotivation or the Associate's resignation.

The law contemplates different modalities of workplace harassment:

- Laboral mistreatment: Violent acts against physical or moral integrity, physical or verbal attacks that affect the integrity, freedom and dignity of the Associate.
- Laboral Discrimination: Differential treatment based on race, sex, family origin, religious beliefs, political preferences or social status.
- Work hindrance: Any action tending to hinder the performance of the work or make it more burdensome or delay it to the detriment of the Associate. They constitute actions of labor impediment, among others, the deprivation, concealment or uselessness of the supplies, documents or instruments for the work, the destruction or loss of information, the concealment of correspondence or electronic messages.
- Labor inequity: Assigning functions to the Associate in a contemptuous way.
- Lack of protection at work: Any conduct tending to jeopardize the integrity and safety of the Associate through orders or assignment of functions without meeting the minimum protection and safety requirements for the Associate.
- Labor persecution: Any conduct whose characteristics of repetition or evident arbitrariness allow inferring the purpose of inducing the resignation of the Associate, through disqualification, excessive workload and permanent changes in hours that may cause labor demotivation.

Sexual harassment

No one, whether or not an Associate, may threaten or suggest that an Associate's submission to or rejection of sexual advances will have any impact on any employment decision affecting the Associate. Examples of prohibited and unlawful sexual harassment include: unwelcome sexual flirting; requests for sexual activity; sending, displaying, or describing sexual images or sexual activity; descriptions of a person or their body in sexual or sex-specific terms; sexually explicit or offensive jokes; sexual gestures; unprofessional or sexual touching of oneself or another; physical or sexual assault or threats; inappropriate staring; or any other unwelcome conduct which a person reasonably believes is based on their sex. Any Associate who believes that they have experienced sexual harassment, who has witnessed another Associate being subjected to sexual harassment, or who is aware of any other Associate who believes that they have been sexually harassed should report that as described later in this Policy.

There will be no adverse action taken by Cognizant against Associate who report violations of this Policy in good faith or participate in the investigation of such violations, unless they have participated in the reported violations, and it is demonstrated that they did.

To file complaints of sexual harassment, in addition to bringing the case to the attention of the Coexistence Committee, the Associate may use to the following governmental mechanisms:

- Línea Púrpura: 01 8000 112137 or WhatsApp 3007551846
- Download the app: APP ELLAS
- Line 155: Presidencial Council for Women's equality (Consejería presidencial para la equidad de la mujer)

Process for handling with workplace harassment complaints

Refer to the [procedure document](#) to know about the process involved in handling workplace harassment complaints.

Confidentiality

The process under Colombian law, including the content of the complaint, the identity, and the address of the complainant, respondent and witnesses, the recommendations of the Coexistence Committee and the actions taken by Cognizant under this Policy, will always be kept confidential by all persons who are privy to the complaint, including, but not limited to.

Please find the Spanish version of the policy [here](#).

India

Under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (POSH), India based Associates may report Sexual Harassment through their location based POSH Committee. For more details, refer to the [Prevention of Sexual Harassment Policy – India](#).

United States

Definition of harassment

In addition to the definition of harassment in the global policy, the US further defines harassment as unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual or gender-based nature when:

- submission to such conduct is either explicitly or implicitly made a term or condition of an individual's employment; or
- submission to or rejection of such conduct is used as the basis for employment decisions affecting the individual; or
- such conduct unreasonably interferes with an individual's work performance or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment.

Retaliation

An individual who reports incidents which, in good faith, they believe to be violations of this policy, or who is involved in the investigation of discriminatory harassment, will not be subject to reprisal or retaliation. Retaliation is a serious violation of this policy and should be reported immediately. The report and investigation of allegations of retaliation will follow the procedures set forth in this policy. Any person found to have retaliated against an individual for reporting discriminatory harassment or for participating in an investigation of allegations of such conduct will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action.

Consensual relationships

Consensual romantic and/or sexual relationships between a manager or supervisor, and non-managers or supervisors, or between an associate with supervisory authority and their subordinate, will compromise Cognizant's ability to enforce its policy against sexual harassment. Romantic relationships within one's own reporting line are prohibited. Consequently, if such relationships arise, they will be considered carefully by Cognizant, and appropriate action will be taken. Such action may include a change in the responsibilities of the individuals involved in such relationships or transfer of location within the office to diminish or eliminate the supervisory relationship and workplace contact that may exist. Any manager or supervisory associate involved in such a relationship is required to report the relationship to your HR Business Partner.

Reporting channels

If you believe that you have been subject to sexual or other discriminatory harassment, or if you have observed or learned about any such harassment, Cognizant requires you to promptly notify your supervisor, manager, HR Business Partner or the Ethics & Compliance Helpline (tel 1-866-824-4897; fax 201-801-0243; website; email chiefcomplianceofficer@cognizant.com).